A Letter Expressing Support for SO1 Anders Fagerstal

November 9, 2026



Gentlemen of The Rittenhouse Club,

I am honored to write in support of Anders Fagerstal's candidacy for membership in The Rittenhouse Club. I have had the pleasure of getting to know Anders over the past two years and believe his intelligence, character, and intellectual curiosity would make him an excellent addition to the Club.

Anders and I first met in 2024 at a monthly poker game organized by a group of Navy SEALs in San Diego. My first impression was how cerebral and inquisitive he was. Our conversations ranged from poker strategy and history to economics and our respective plans for life after the military.

During that first meeting, Anders mentioned his interest in graduate school, which was particularly amusing because I had submitted my application to Wharton just the week prior. What stood out to me was how deliberate and goal-oriented he was about his future. He had a clear plan for transitioning out of the Navy and pursuing his professional ambitions. Over the following months, we continued to see each other at these poker games, where I grew to appreciate both his accomplishments and his character.

Prior to his military service, Anders graduated from UCLA with a Bachelor of Science in Mathematics-Economics. He joined the Navy in 2017 and served with SEAL Team FIVE, completing two deployments to the Middle East and Indo-Pacific regions. Throughout his career, he served as a Joint Terminal Attack Controller, Sniper, and Fireteam Leader. In 2023, he pursued selection for Naval Special Warfare Development Group before completing his final two years of service as a Maritime Interdiction Operations Instructor in San Diego.

Beyond his military accomplishments, Anders has a genuine interest in finance, global affairs, economics, and emerging technologies. He is equally comfortable discussing complex geopolitical issues as he is enjoying an evening of poker, golf, or good conversation among friends. Despite everything he has accomplished, Anders remains humble, approachable, and genuinely curious about those around him. He brings substance to conversations without taking himself too seriously, a quality I have come to respect through our friendship. I am confident he would be a valued addition to the brotherhood and traditions of The Rittenhouse Club.

Anders Fagerstals's candidacy is seconded by SO2 Alex Bilay.

In the Bonds,

SO2 Joe Nomellini
The Rittenhouse Club
Class of 2027

